WordCraft Connector for Zotero: Installation Guide (Windows)

Version 0.1.0 (early release). An unofficial add-on, not affiliated with Zotero or the WordCraft team.

What this does

WordCraft is a free, open-source word processor that reads and writes .docx files. This add-on lets you select references in Zotero, right-click, and insert the citation or bibliography straight into the WordCraft document you are writing, formatted in your chosen citation style (APA, IEEE, Chicago and any other style installed in Zotero).

Citations are inserted as plain text for now: no italics and no live citation fields.

What you need

- Windows 10 or 11
- Zotero 7 or newer (zotero.org/download)
- WordCraft (Step 1)
- The add-on file `wordcraft-zotero-0.1.0.xpi` (download: [add your link here])

Step 1: Install WordCraft

1. Open the WordCraft releases page: github.com/storytold/wordcraft/releases/latest
2. Download one of these (choose the x64 build unless your PC is ARM or 32-bit):
   - `wordcraft-<version>-windows-user-x64.msi`: installer for your account only, no administrator rights needed. It installs into `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\WordCraft`.
   - `wordcraft-<version>-windows-x64-portable.zip`: no installation; right-click, choose Extract All, and use the extracted folder.

Step 2: Start WordCraft with its connection port

The add-on talks to WordCraft through a port on your own computer, and WordCraft only opens it when started with a flag. Starting it from the Start menu will not work for this.

1. Open the folder that contains `wordcraft.exe`. For the installer, paste `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\WordCraft` into the File Explorer address bar and press Enter.
2. Click the address bar, type `powershell` and press Enter. A terminal opens in that folder.
3. Run:

```
.\wordcraft.exe --control 7981
```

WordCraft opens and the terminal stays quiet. That is normal. Keep WordCraft running while you cite.

Tip: to start it with one click, right-click `wordcraft.exe`, choose Create shortcut, then open the shortcut's Properties and add `--control 7981` at the end of the Target box (after the closing quote).

Step 3: Install the add-on in Zotero

1. In Zotero, open Tools, then Plugins.
2. Click the gear icon and choose Install Plugin From File.
3. Select `wordcraft-zotero-0.1.0.xpi`, then restart Zotero if asked.

Step 4: Check the connection

With WordCraft running, choose Tools, then WordCraft: Test Connection in Zotero. A small popup should say it connected. If it does, you are done.

Step 5: Cite

1. Click inside your WordCraft document where the citation should go.
2. In Zotero, select one or more items and right-click.
3. Choose Cite in WordCraft to insert the in-text citation, or Insert Bibliography in WordCraft to insert the formatted reference entries.

The citation style follows Zotero's Quick Copy setting (Zotero Settings, Export, Item Format).

Troubleshooting

- Popup says it couldn't reach WordCraft: WordCraft is not running, or was not started with `--control 7981`. Close it and repeat Step 2.
- Popup says the control key was rejected: close WordCraft and start it again with the command in Step 2.
- WordCraft's window flashes and closes: this is a known graphics-driver issue on some PCs. In the same PowerShell window run `$env:WGPU_BACKEND = "vulkan"` and then the command from Step 2 again.
- The right-click and Tools menu entries are missing: confirm you are on Zotero 7 or newer and restart Zotero after installing.
- Need a different port: change `extensions.wordcraft.port` in Zotero's Settings, Advanced, Config Editor, and start WordCraft with the same number.

Privacy

Everything stays on your computer. The add-on connects only to `127.0.0.1`, WordCraft's local port, and sends nothing over the internet.

Known limits

This is an early version, and WordCraft itself is in alpha. Please report problems with the exact message shown so they can be fixed.